Installing HeartStor ChMS

This guide explains how to install the **HeartStor Church Management System (ChMS)** using the official installation package.

HeartStor ChMS runs on **Windows systems (32-bit and 64-bit)** and is **network-ready**, allowing multiple users to access the system in shared environments.

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1. Download the Installation Package

The installation package can be downloaded from the official website:

https://heartstor4free.github.io/

Download the installer file:

`HS64_Setup.exe or HS32_Setup.exe`

Save the file to a location on your computer such as the **Downloads** folder or Desktop.

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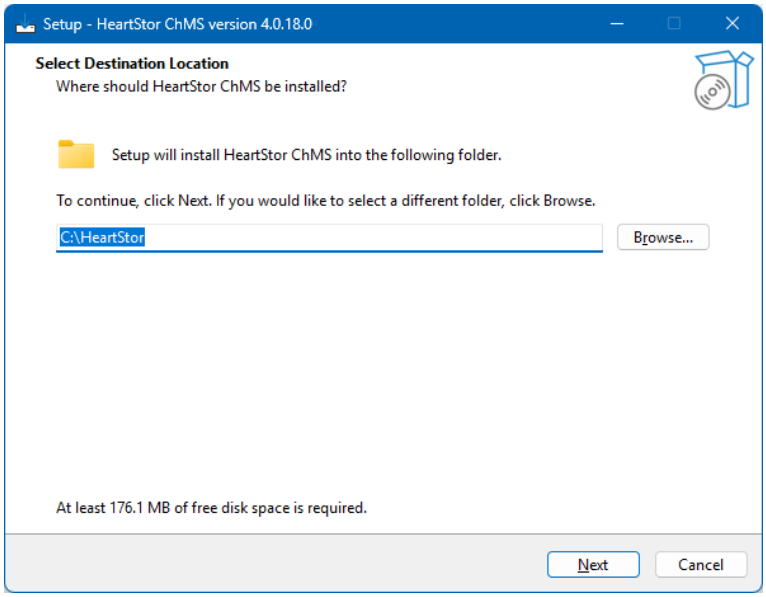
2. Start the Installation

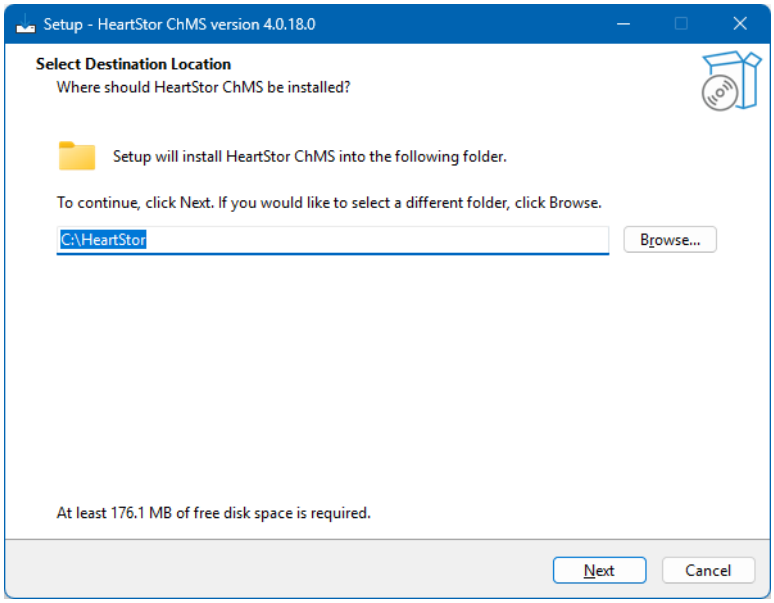
1. Locate the downloaded file **HS64_Setup.exe** or **HS32_Setup.exe**.
2. Double-click the file to start the installation.

It is recommended to **run the installer as Administrator** to ensure the program installs correctly.



3. Select the Installation Folder

During installation you will be prompted to select the folder where **HeartStor ChMS** will be installed.



The recommended location is:

```
C:\HeartStor
```

This location is recommended to avoid **permission issues** that may occur when installing in the Windows **Program Files** folder.

You may choose another location if required.

Click **Next** to continue.

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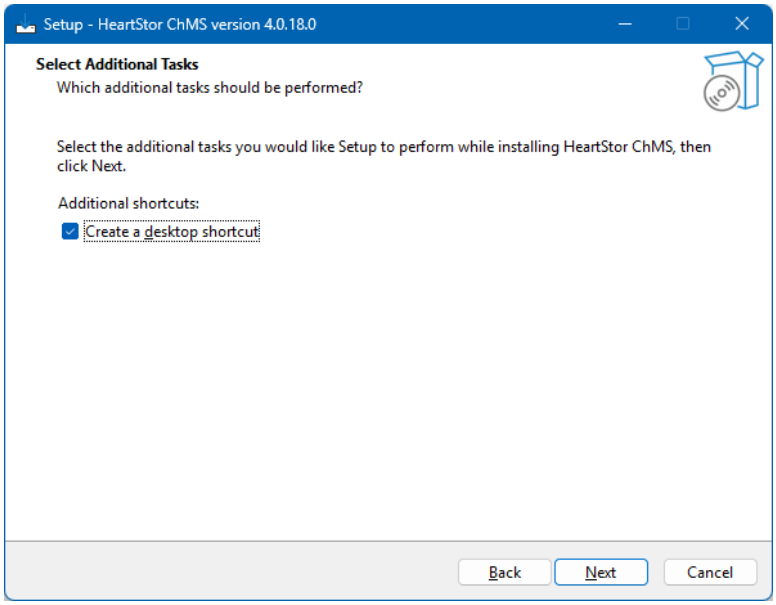
4. Create Desktop Shortcut

The next screen allows you to choose whether to create a **Desktop Shortcut** for HeartStor ChMS.



This shortcut allows quick access to the system.

1. Select the option if you want a desktop icon.
2. Click **Next** to continue.

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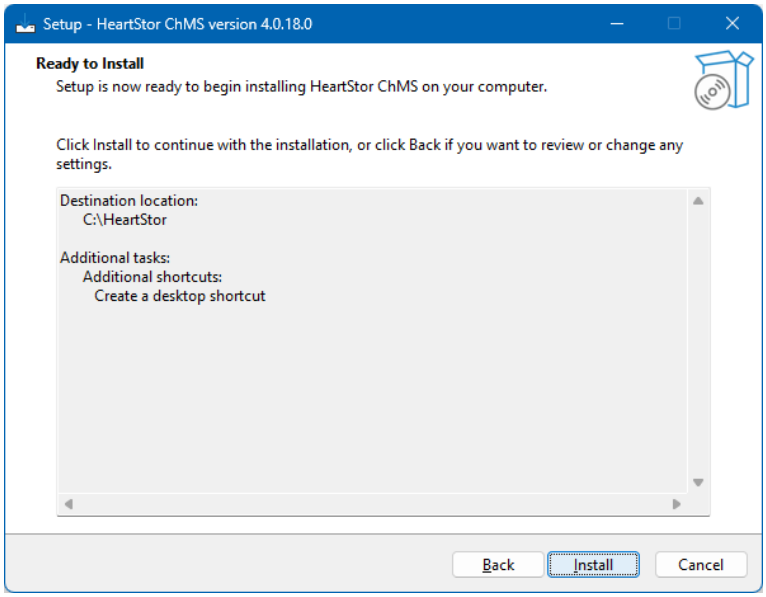
5. Begin the Installation

You will now see the final installation confirmation screen.



1. Click the **Install** button to begin installing the program.

The installer will now copy all required program files to your computer.

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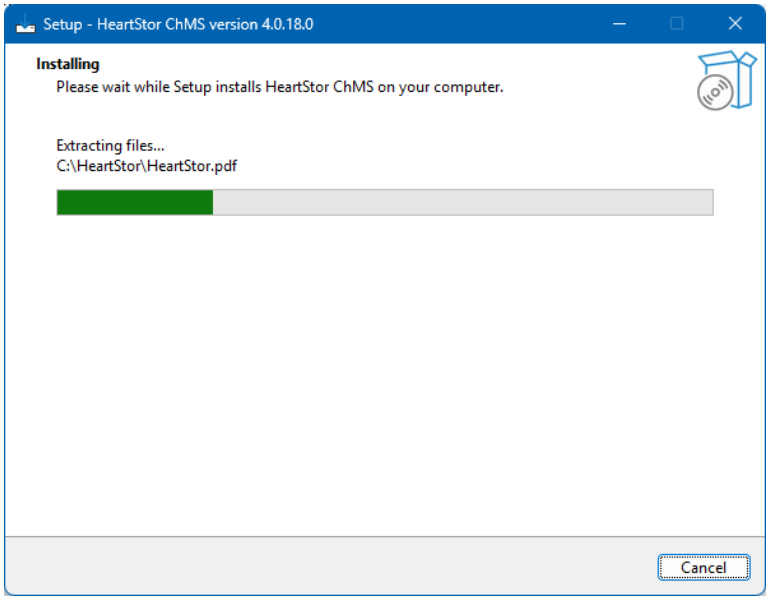
6. Installation Progress

A **progress bar** will display the installation status while the files are being installed.



Wait until the installation process is completed.

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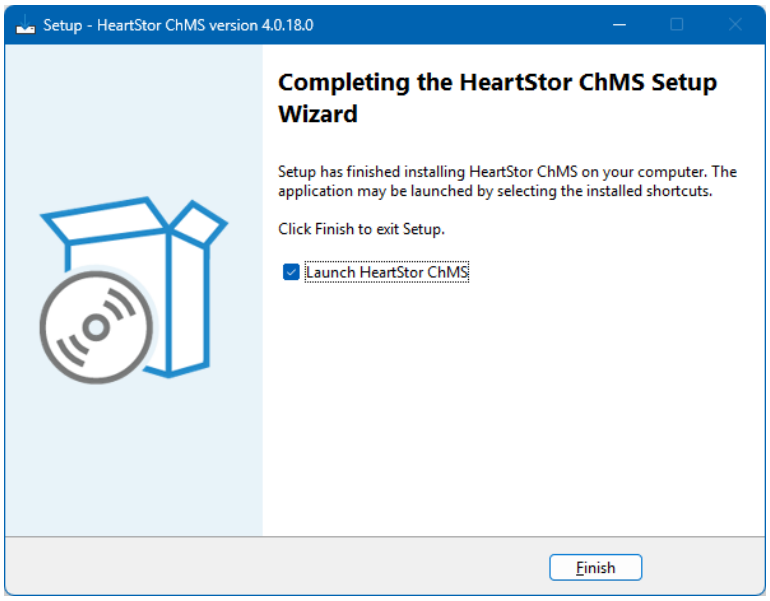
7. Complete the Installation

Once installation is complete, the final screen will appear.



You will see an option to:

Launch HeartStor ChMS

1. Select the option if you want to start the program immediately.
2. Click **Finish** to exit the installer.

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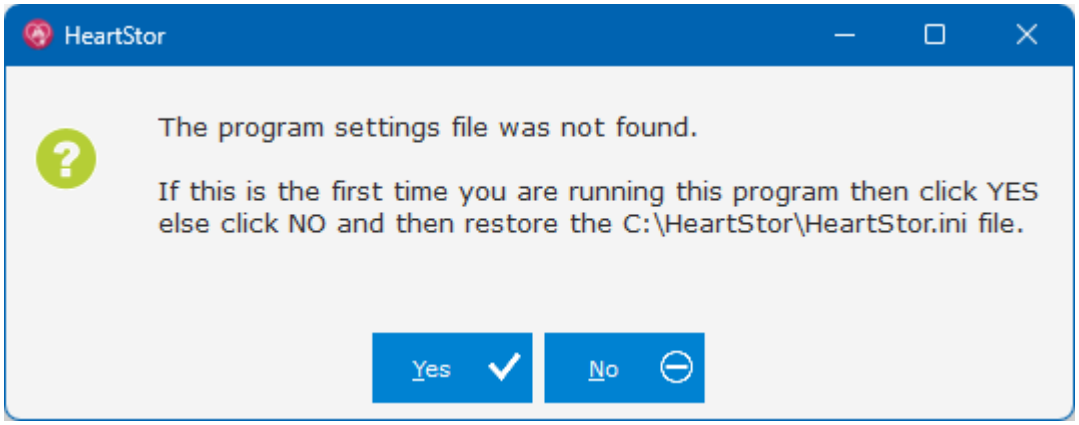
8. First Time Startup

When running HeartStor ChMS for the first time, the system will display the following message:



"The program settings file was not found."

This is **normal behaviour during the first installation**.

1. Click **Yes** to create the program settings file.

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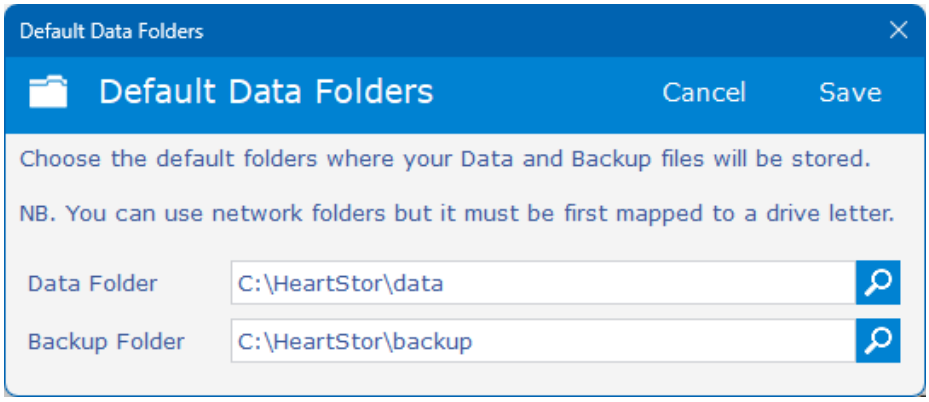
9. Configure Default Data Folders

Next, you will be prompted to configure the **Default Data Folders**.



These folders are used to store:

- Church databases
- System data
- Backup files

You will see two folder settings:

- **Data Folder**
- **Backup Folder**

You may:

- Click **Save** to accept the default folders, or
- Specify different folders if required.

For **multi-user environments**, these folders may be located on a **mapped network drive** so that multiple users can access the same data.

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10. Login Screen

After configuring the folders, the **Login Screen** will appear.

For first-time users, use the following default credentials:

```
User ID: admin
Password: admin
```

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11. Select a Database

Before logging in, select a database from the **Database dropdown list**.

During the first installation, a sample database is automatically created:

HeartStor Church – Demo 1

This database contains sample data so you can explore the system and learn how it works.

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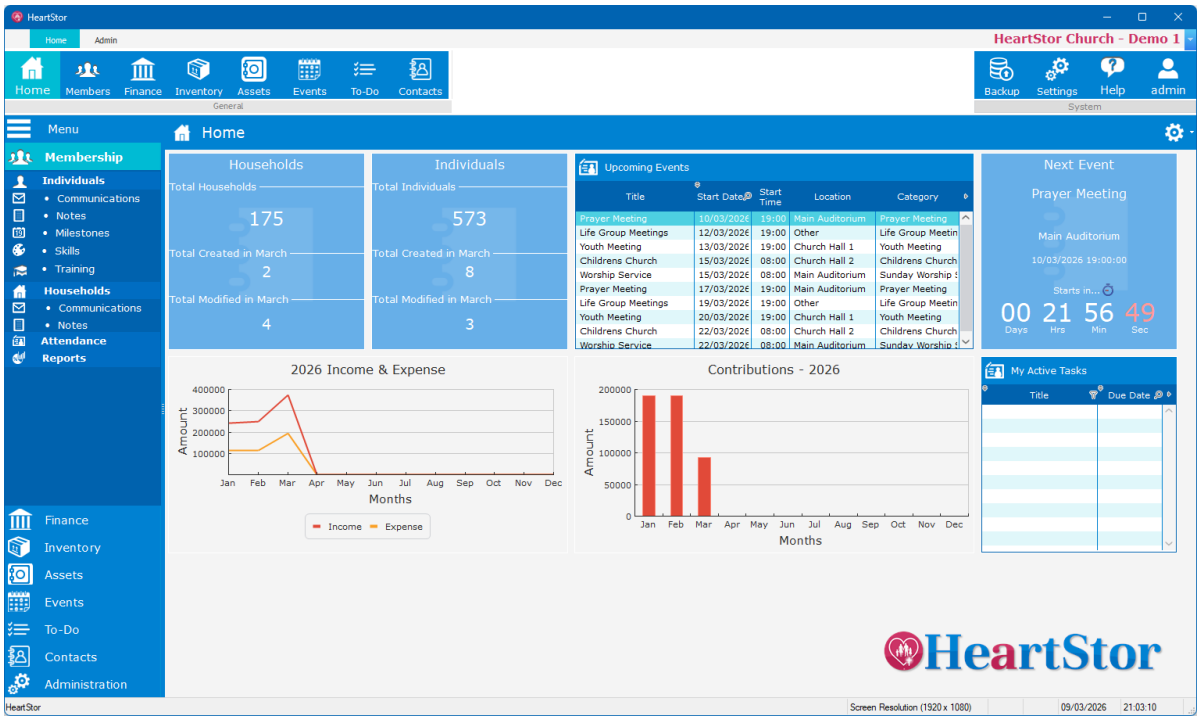
12. Login to the System

1. Enter the login credentials.
2. Select the database.
3. Click **Login**.

HeartStor ChMS will now open and you can begin using the system.

Installation Complete

You have now successfully installed **HeartStor ChMS**.



You can begin:

- Exploring the demo database
- Creating your own church database
- Configuring system settings
- Adding members and financial records

Recommended Next Steps

After installation you may want to:

- Review **Church Settings**
- Create a **new church database**
- Add **users**
- Configure **Email Setup**
- Import existing member data using **CSV Import**